

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
RUMOMASI**

TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: SEVEN

CLASS: SS2

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Comprehension: Inference

Introduction

- Inference is reading between the lines — understanding what the writer implies but does not state directly. It is tested in 'what does the writer suggest?', 'what can be inferred about...?' questions.

How to infer

- Look for clues: word choice, details, tone, contrast and cause-effect. Ask: 'What do these details point to?' Combine the clues with common sense. A passage about a broken-down bus in a deserted road at night 'suggests' fear or danger — even if the writer never says 'they were afraid'. Inference marks go to answers supported by the text, not guesses.

Practice questions

- If the writer says 'the doctor's waiting room was full by 7 a.m.', you may infer that the clinic is popular or that people are ill — but not that the doctor is lazy. Distinguish inference from fact: facts are stated; inferences are suggested.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Define inference.
2. Why must an inference be supported by the passage?
3. Infer the writer's attitude from: 'The so-called renovation added a fresh coat of paint to the same old problems.'
4. Differentiate between a fact and an inference.

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: EIGHT

CLASS: SS2

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Formal Letters

Introduction

- Formal letters are written for official purposes: applications, complaints, enquiries, invitations, letters to newspapers and letters to officials. They follow a strict format and a formal tone.

Format

- The writer's address and date (top right); the recipient's address (left); the salutation (Dear Sir/Madam, Dear Dr Okoro); the subject heading in capitals; the body (title or purpose in the first sentence, details in the middle, and a clear closing sentence); the subscription (Yours faithfully for Sir/Madam, Yours sincerely for a named person); signature and full name in block capitals.

Language and content

- Impersonal, polite, standard English; no slang, no contractions (write 'I am', not 'I'm'); each paragraph a new point; specific details (dates, names, amounts, references); and a courteous tone even in complaints.

Sample outline (application)

- Paragraph 1 — the post applied for and where it was advertised; Paragraph 2 — age, education, experience; Paragraph 3 — character, availability, referees; Paragraph 4 — a request for an interview and thanks.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. List the parts of a formal letter in order.
2. Write the opening paragraph of a letter of complaint about a faulty product.
3. When do you use 'Yours faithfully'?
4. State three features of formal letter language.

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: NINE

CLASS: SS2

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Informal Letters

Introduction

- Informal (personal) letters are written to friends, relations and acquaintances. They are warm, conversational and personal — but still must be correctly formatted, coherent and carefully written.

Format

- The writer's address and date (top right); a friendly salutation (Dear John, My dear Aunty); an opening that asks about the recipient's health and well-being; the body in paragraphs (the news, the reason for writing); a closing with good wishes (Yours sincerely, Your loving son, With love); the signature; and often a postscript (P.S.). No recipient's address, no title, no 'Yours faithfully'.

Language

- Relaxed and natural — contractions are acceptable (I'm, we'll); the tone is affectionate, humorous or serious as the news requires; but the letter must still be written in correct English, in paragraphs, with a clear sequence of ideas.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. List the parts of an informal letter.
2. Write the opening of a letter to your father telling him about your results.
3. State two differences between informal and formal letters.
4. Is a P.S. acceptable in a formal letter? Why? (Use an example.)

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TEN

CLASS: SS2

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Argumentative Essays

Introduction

- An argumentative essay argues a case for or against a proposition, using reasoned evidence. Examples: 'Boarding school is better than day school'; 'Girls should not be allowed to study sciences' (argue against).

Plan

- **Introduction** — state the topic and take a definite stand.
- **Body** — 3–4 arguments, each in its own paragraph: topic sentence → explanation → evidence or example → link to the proposition.
- **Rebuttal** — concede and answer the opposing view ('Admittedly... however...').
- **Conclusion** — restate the stand strongly and briefly.

Language

- Persuasive but formal; linkers of concession (although, even though) and cause (therefore, consequently); modal verbs (must, ought to); rhetorical questions; statistics and examples; no abuse of the opponents; no slang. Write 450 words, 5–6 paragraphs.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Outline a plan arguing that examination malpractice should attract stiffer penalties.
2. Why is a rebuttal important?
3. Give two persuasive devices.
4. State the length and paragraph plan expected in an exam essay.

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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: ELEVEN

CLASS: SS2

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Summary Skills

Introduction

- Summary writing compresses a passage into a stated number of sentences or words, keeping only the points that answer the question, in the candidate's own words.

Procedure

- Read the passage twice (once for the gist, once with the question); identify the key points; write each point as a short sentence; sequence the points as they appear; keep to the word limit; count the words and write the number at the end.

Do's and don'ts

- Do: use your own words; give exactly the number of points asked; keep the order; be concise; answer what is asked.
- Do not: lift whole sentences from the passage; exceed the limit; add your own opinions; repeat points; mix two answers in one sentence.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. State the steps of summary writing.
2. Summarise in one sentence: 'The school library is well stocked, the reading room is quiet, and the librarian is helpful.'
3. Why is lifting from the passage penalised?
4. What is the importance of the word limit?

**NAME OF SCHOOL: MATER MISERICORDIAE SECONDARY SCHOOL,
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TERM: SECOND 2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION

WEEK: TWELVE

CLASS: SS2

SUBJECT: English Language

TOPIC: Oral English & Speech Work

Introduction

- Oral English tests the spoken language: the sounds of English (vowels and consonants), word stress, sentence stress and intonation. Speech work also covers the skills of public speaking — clear delivery before an audience.

Vowel and consonant sounds

- English has 12 pure vowels (see /i/, sit /i/, bed /e/, cat /æ/, car /ɑ:/, hot /ɒ/, saw /ɔ:/, put /ʊ/, food /u/, cup /ʌ/, bird /ɜ:/, the schwa /ə/) and 8 diphthongs (day /eɪ/, my /aɪ/, boy /ɔɪ/, go /oʊ/, now /aʊ/, ear /ɪə/, air /eə/, tour /tʊə/); 24 consonants including the pairs that trouble Nigerian speakers: /θ/ think vs /s/ sink, /ð/ this vs /d/ the, /v/ vest vs /w/ west, /ʃ/ sheep vs /tʃ/ chip.

Stress and intonation

- Word stress: REcord (noun) vs reCORD (verb), PHOtograph vs phoTOgraphy; compound nouns stress the first part (BLACKboard). Sentence stress falls on content words; function words are reduced. Intonation: falling for statements and wh-questions, rising for yes/no questions and lists (except the last item).

Public speaking skills

- Prepare the topic; speak clearly, slowly and audibly; use the eyes, gestures and posture; control nervousness by breathing and practice; handle the audience's questions politely; and end with a summary or a call to action.

CLASS EVALUATION

1. Write the phonetic symbols for: see, cat, bird, car.
2. Distinguish /θ/ from /s/ with examples.
3. Place the stress on 'photograph' and 'photography'.
4. Which intonation does a yes/no question take?
5. State three rules of good public speaking.